

Employee Chemical Handling Program

The purpose of this program is to ensure all AG Composites employees work in a safe environment. It is paramount that everyone follows established procedures to prevent injuries, illnesses, or death. If at any time an employee sees another employee not following procedures, they should correct the employee or immediately notify the department leader or The Safety Team. Correcting procedures is not to get anyone in trouble but rather to keep them safe.

The Safety Team and the department leaders will ensure all employees are trained before allowing them to perform their work duties. Refresher training will occur annually or when there is a new chemical / tool introduced to the production process.

Success is defined when employees demonstrate the following:

1. Location and knowledge of Safety Data Sheets
2. Understand the risks associated with the chemicals, procedures to protect themselves and fellow employees, proper storage, and disposal of hazardous chemicals
3. Understand general facility safety measures (e.g., evacuation procedures, having a clean / safe work area, spill procedures, etc.)
4. They understand and can perform their work duties safely and effectively

Chemical Handling Procedures

1. When handling and storing any chemicals, always refer to the Safety Data Sheet (SDS) for best practices.
2. Determine if the employee can read and understand basic English.
3. Inform the employee where the Safety Data Sheets (SDS) and Hazard Communication Program can be found.
4. Train the employee how to read a Safety Data Sheet.
5. Teach the employee that there are only two words used as signal words, "Danger" and "Warning." Within a specific hazard class, "Danger" is used for the more severe hazards and "Warning" is used for the less severe hazards. There will only be one signal word on the label no matter how many hazards a chemical may have.
6. Identify all chemicals used in the workspace and what each chemical is used for.
7. Show the employee the proper area and method for storing chemicals.
8. Demonstrate how to properly handle the chemical and what personal protective equipment (PPE) is required.
9. Discuss symptoms or signs of overexposure to the chemicals and proper response to any unhealthy exposure. Use the SDS to aid in this process.
10. Discuss how to determine if there has been an accidental release of a chemical and the proper response / clean up.
11. Train the employee on the different pictograms on chemical containers.



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12. Train the employee on the proper methods for daily and weekly cleaning of equipment and work area.
13. Utilize the Learning Evaluation Checklist to determine the employee's knowledge
14. Train the employee on acute vs chronic illnesses.
 - **Acute** illnesses generally develop suddenly and last a short time, often only a few days or weeks.
 - **Chronic** conditions develop slowly and may worsen over an extended period of time—months to years.
15. Example Pictograms

Health Hazard  • Carcinogen • Mutagenicity • Reproductive Toxicity • Respiratory Sensitizer • Target Organ Toxicity • Aspiration Toxicity	Flame  • Flammables • Pyrophorics • Self-Heating • Emits Flammable Gas • Self-Reactives • Organic Peroxides	Exclamation Mark  • Irritant (skin and eye) • Skin Sensitizer • Acute Toxicity (harmful) • Narcotic Effects • Respiratory Tract Irritant • Hazardous to Ozone Layer (Non-Mandatory)
Gas Cylinder  • Gases Under Pressure	Corrosion  • Skin Corrosion/ Burns • Eye Damage • Corrosive to Metals	Exploding Bomb  • Explosives • Self-Reactives • Organic Peroxides
Flame Over Circle  • Oxidizers	Environment (Non-Mandatory)  • Aquatic Toxicity	Skull and Crossbones  • Acute Toxicity (fatal or toxic)



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Learning Evaluation Checklist

Determine the effectiveness of training by using this checklist.

1. Give an employee an SDS, have them locate three (3) pieces of designated information
2. Worker will understand the general hazards and symptoms of chemicals in their area
3. Employee will know how to evacuate a workstation in the event of a fire
4. Employee understands steps to take in reporting a leak or spill
5. In a true-false quiz, worker will correctly differentiate between the meanings of “acute” and “chronic”
6. Employee will learn how to identify hazardous situations such as spills
7. The employee will know the location of the hazard communication written program and the SDS books.



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